

UNDESTANDING TYPES OF INNOVATION NETWORK

NETWORK TYPE	EXAMPLES
Entrepreneur-based	Bringing different complementary resources together to help take an opportunity forward. This strategy is largely dependent on the entrepreneur's energy and enthusiasm in getting people interested in joining—and staying in—the network.
Communities of practice	Networks that involve players inside and across different organizations. They are bound together by a shared concern with a particular aspect or area of knowledge.
Spatial cluster	These form where key players in a given industry are situated in the same geographical area—Silicon Valley is a good example. Knowledge flow among and across the members of the network is helped by the geographical closeness and the ability of key players to meet and talk.
Sectoral network	These bring different players together because they share a common market sector or business model, and often have the purpose of shared innovation to preserve competitiveness.
New product or process development network	Networks that share knowledge and perspectives to create and market a new product or process concept across more than one organization.
Learning network	Working together across a sector or region to improve competitiveness through product, process, and service innovation.
New technology development network	Sharing and learning around newly emerging technologies to fully explore their potential—for example, the pioneering semiconductor research programs in the US and Japan that join resources and information from universities across the globe.
Emerging standards	Exploring and establishing standards around innovative technologies—for example, the Motion Picture Experts Group (MPEG) that works on audio and video compression standards for digital sound and video.
Supply chain learning	Developing and sharing innovative good practice and possibly shared product development across a value chain, such as between manufacture and distribution.